

I used for document compilation were not collaborative and built for research. As a result, a substantial amount of man-hours was wasted on formatting and re-formatting.”

Winning AngelHack came as a boon. This global hackathon was started first in 2011 at San Francisco and is now run in over a hundred cities globally.

Big promise?

Typeset’s promise is big: to make the work easy for researchers, so they can focus on their prime job – research, and not battle with setting down the words on a page. Plus it offers a lot more, related to the entire process of publishing, distributing, and promoting work with a faster time-to-market.

But it’s not just that.

Chandha explains: “The world’s scientists are working to solve humanity’s most pressing problems. Unfortunately, they are equipped with archaic [computer] tools, with knowledge stored in unstructured formats and published in two-dimensional PDF format without the underlying data/code. This impedes the speed of discovering or building upon valuable information. I believe that in order to change the way in which research is disseminated, we have to change the way research is written. It’s important to fix these foundational issues to accelerate science.”

Typeset started in August 2015, to “solve the productivity program in formatting content for researchers,” Chandha said in an online interview. It might seem like a trivial or boring problem. Yet, no researcher wants to spend hours upon hours each day to just format according to a journal’s guidelines.

Usually, this process is pretty tedious. First, you need to Google and find a particular journal’s guidelines. Then, you have to decide to set your text in Open Office, Microsoft Word, or Apple Pages word processing software.

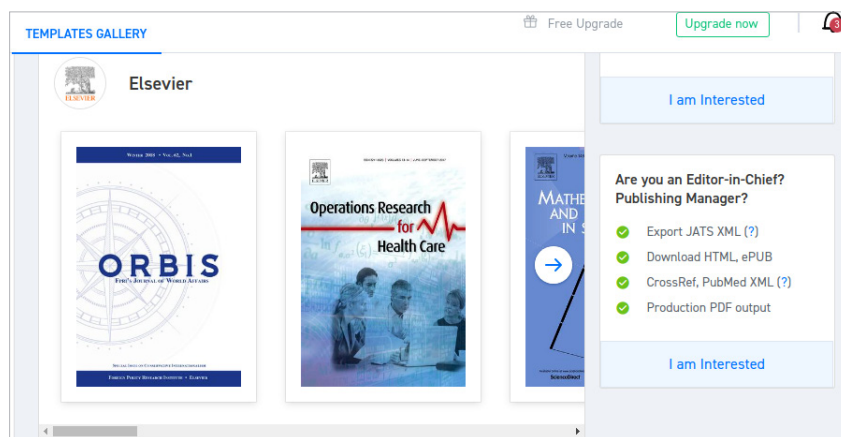


Figure 2: Typeset templates

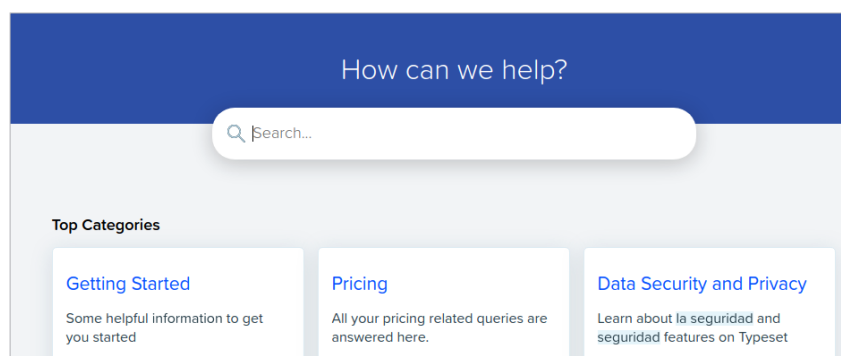


Figure 3: Typeset help

Or, you could learn LaTeX, the powerful if complicated free software tool for document preparation.

Imagine the millions of hours spent by some of the top brains worldwide, in documenting their work.

Explains Chandha: “Our value proposition is that you don’t have to do any of that. You will get a full-blown collaborative word processor, in which you write or cut-and-paste your research content. You could [create] sections, sub-sections, authors, equations....” Even equations can be simply created.

Typeset is a full-blown online editor for research writing. On the left side of the website, as its founder explained, you could add authors, keyboards and all your text.

“If I want to format my content for an IEEE journal, all I need to do is click the button. Then, in a panel on the right side of the website, the

content that I’ve imported or am writing just then, is getting formatted immediately with [for example] the IEEE requirements.” (The 1963-formed Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) publishes nearly a third of the world’s technical literature on electrical engineering, computer science, and electronics.)

Support for typesetting, citations, and the rest of academic writing is “all inbuilt.” You can edit references. If you’re using any reference library software, you can import that directly into the Typeset.io site.

“Some authors might want to go in for some customisation. If they want to change the bibliography style, there are very many styles available on the platform. We also have a plagiarism check,” he adds. You can download your content in diverse formats — PDF, DocX, LateX, or epub.